Synthèse anglais

Wild animals' captivity under scrutiny

In recent years, a rise in concern toward animal wellbeing lead to opposition against the captivity of wild species. The first article (doc 1) published in Born free USA, blames circuses while in the 2nd artcile (doc2), on the website theguardian.com, on February 2020, journalist Robin Mc Kie targets zoos. Published on the RFI on January 2021, the third document (doc3) reports the end of Parc Astérix's dolphin shows. The last document (doc4) is a promotional image featuring captive wild animals. These documents beg the question : is animal captivity an enemy to wildlife ? While it can be exploitative it can sometimes be necessary for conservation

First, the captivity of wild animals can certainly be harmful for their living conditions. Doc 1 demonstrates just how horrible for them the circus life can get, as people exploit them for a profit, without caring about education or the protection of these endangered species. Moreover, even in more hospitable places, like zoos, those animals cannot show their true nature in those small enclosed spaces, as underlines doc2. And this is not an opinion reserved to fierce activists, as in the general French population, doc 4 reminds that 70% of people think "animal rights" aren't taken "seriously enough" by politicians. However, circuses keep selling this glamourous image of happy animals on doc 4, smiling anthropomorphised animals, completelt devoid of their original nature, to better appeal to the public.

However, it can't be ignored that keeping wildlife in captivity is sometimes unavoidable in order to preserve planet Earth. Sometimes, endangered species are present in captivity because they'd go extinct otherwise. If they weren't put in captivity temporarily, as doc 2 reminds us. Another use for zoos can be for studying species to better understand and protect them. Doc 1 even reminds us that it is in fact, the very first function of zoos historically.